

How to use GH and GH Desktop

Minimal usage

Simon Vizner

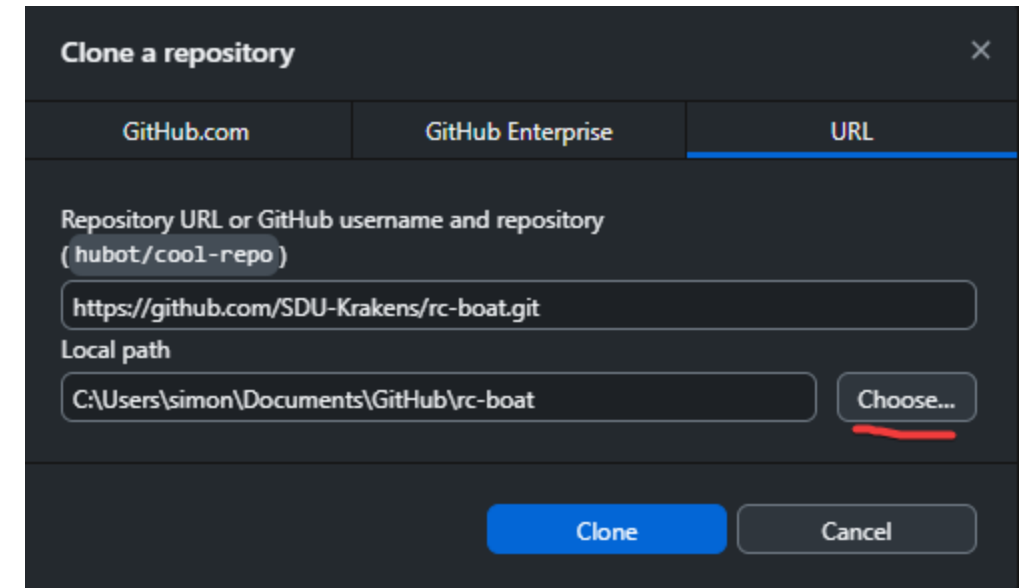
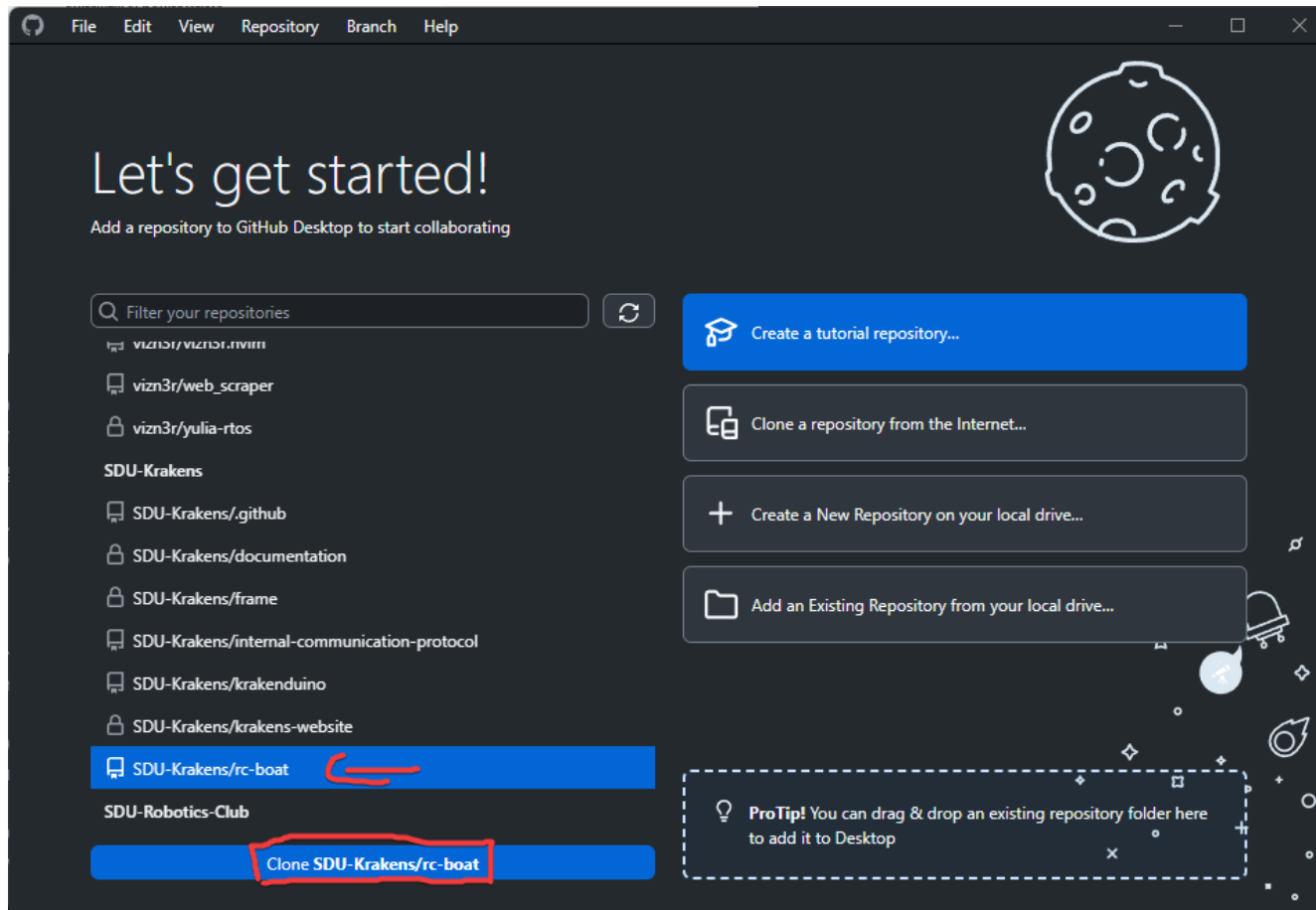
Terms we will be using

- **Repository** - A storage location for your project that tracks all files and their history
- **Local repository** - Git repository on your computer
- **Remote repository** - Git repository hosted on a server (like GitHub)
- **Origin** - The default name for the remote repository on GitHub
- **Branch** - A separate line of development in the repository
- **'main'** - The primary branch containing stable code
- **Fetch** - Download latest changes from remote without merging
- **Commit** - Save changes to local repository with a message
- **Add** - Stage files for commit
- **Push** - Upload local commits to remote repository
- **Merge** - Combine changes from one branch into another
- **Pull request** - Request to merge your branch into main for review

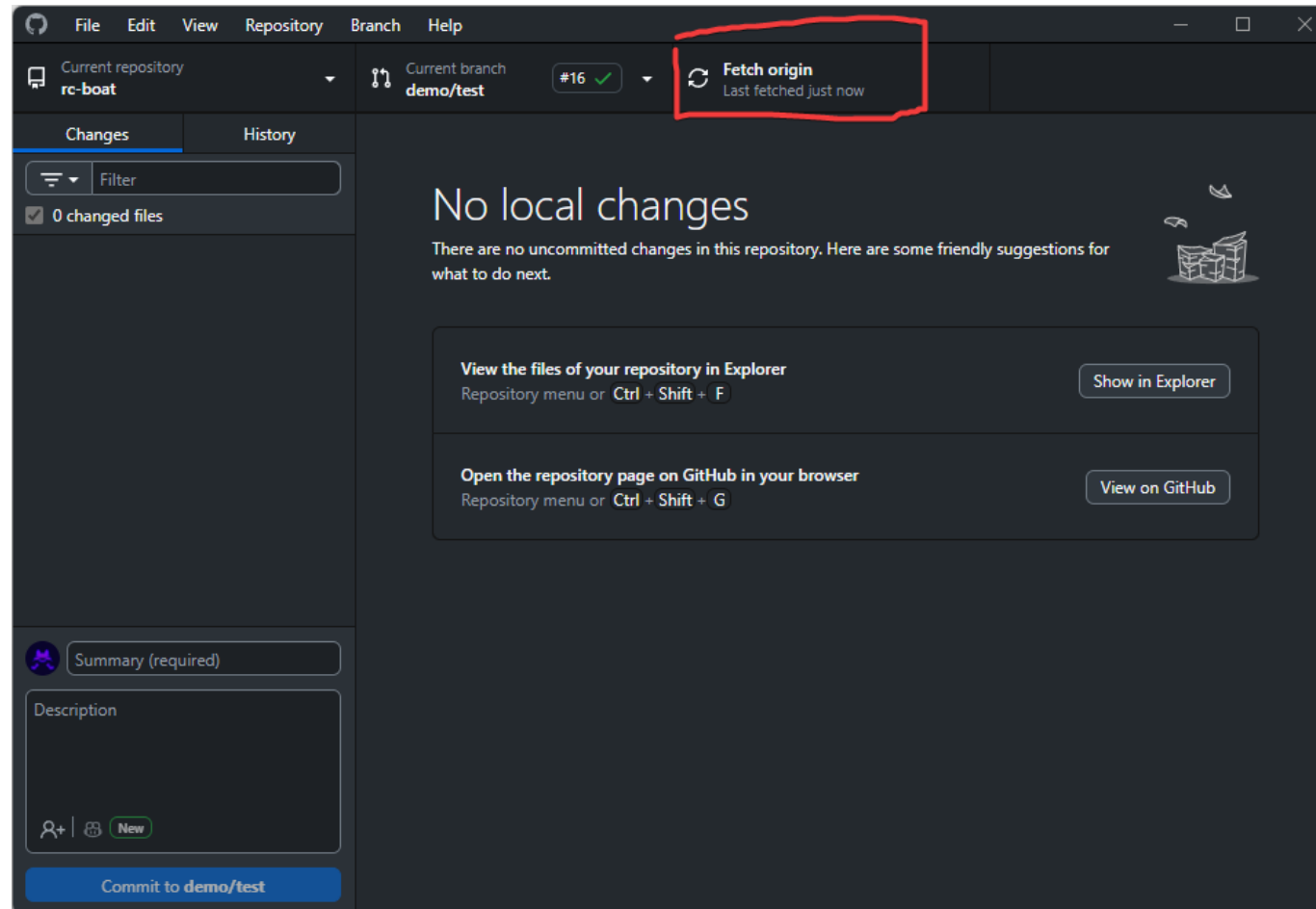
The workflow

- Switch to 'main' branch
- Pull latest changes from origin
- Switch to or create new feature branch (feat/feature-name)
- Make your changes
- Add and commit changes to local repository
- Push to origin
- Create a pull request
- Get code reviewed and accepted

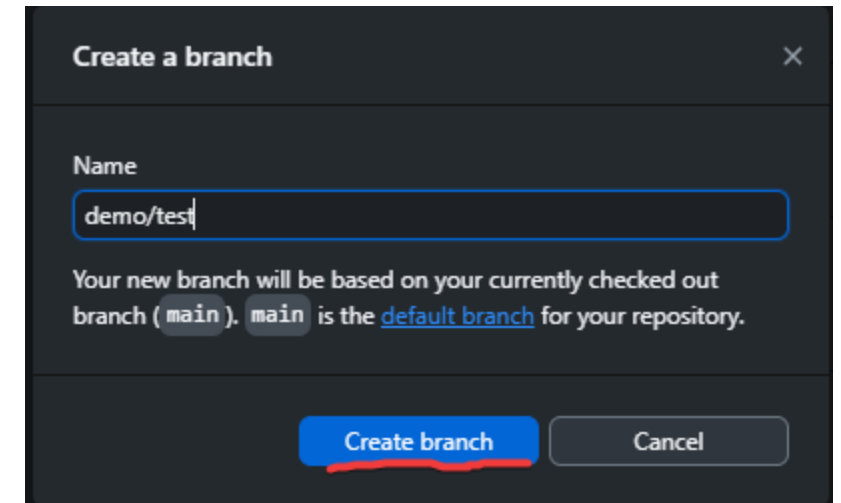
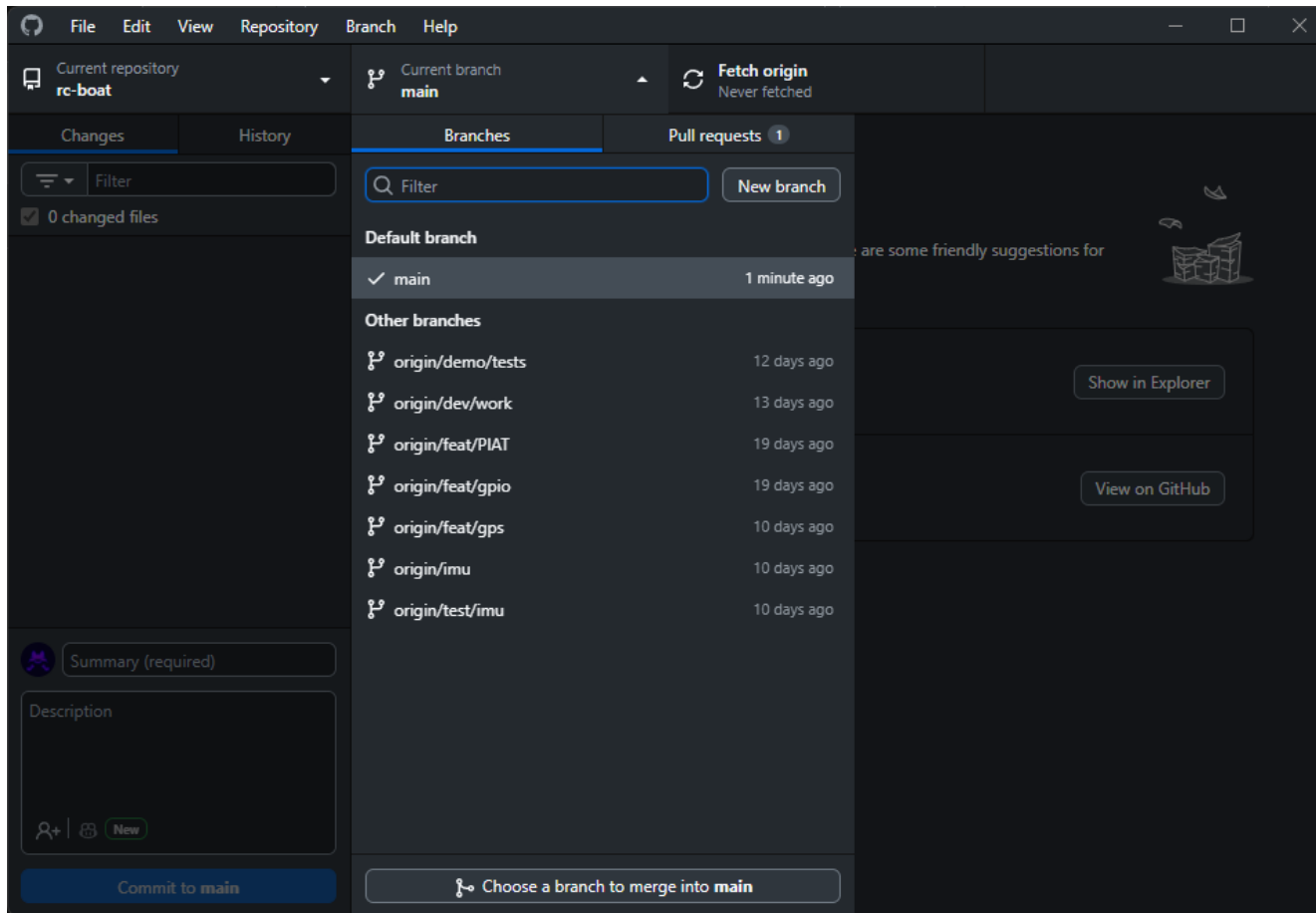
Clone the repository if you haven't already



Fetch the changes from the 'main' branch



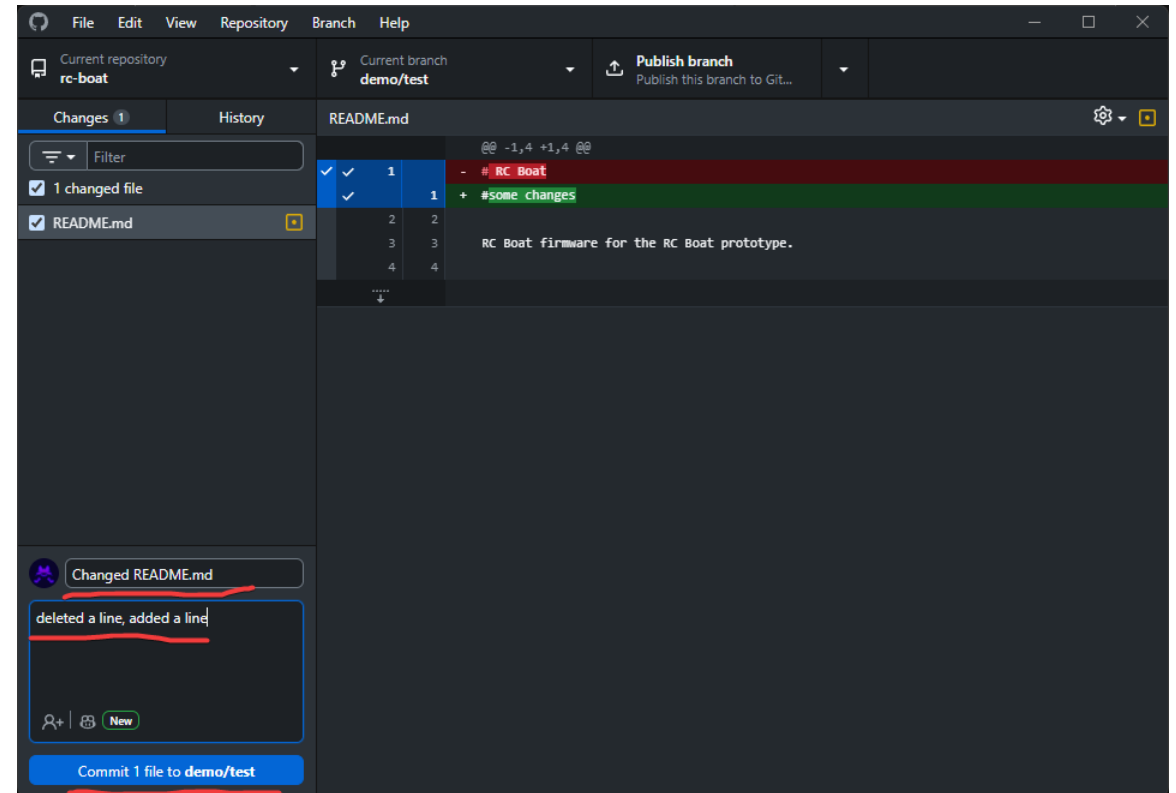
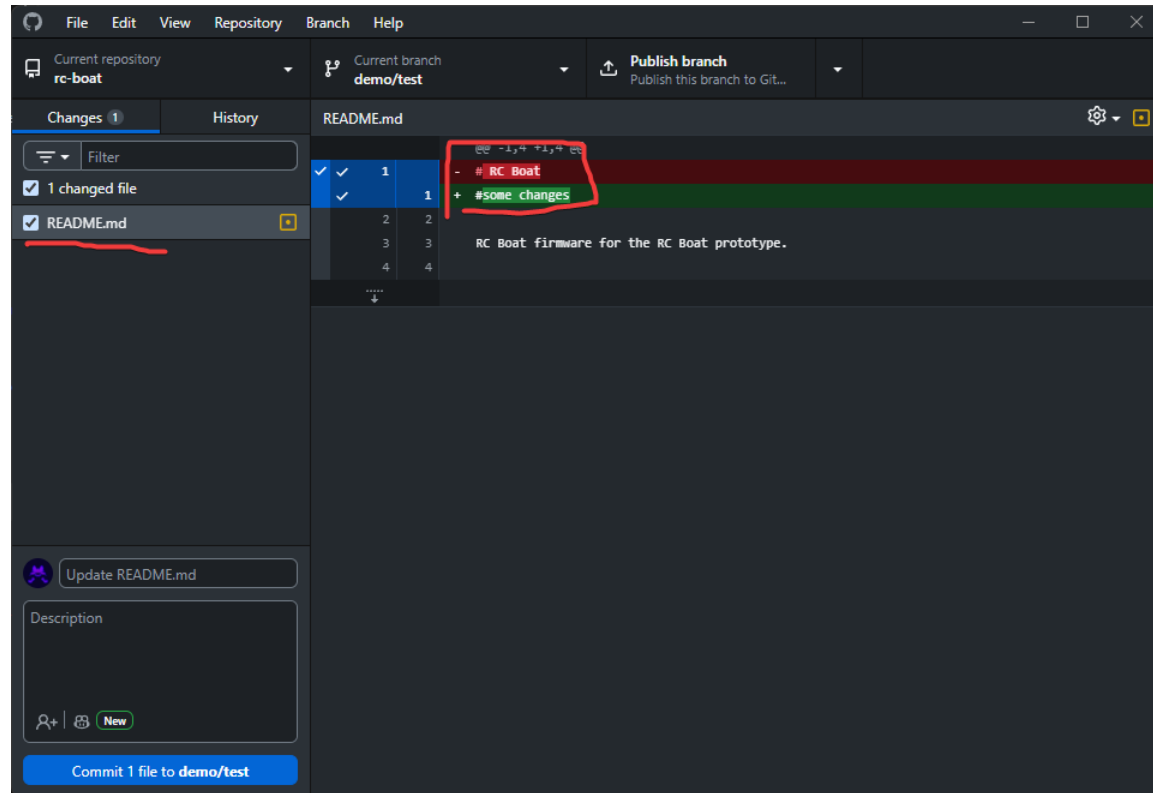
Select or create the right branch



Branch naming rules

- Use `feature/` or `feat/` prefix for new features (e.g., `feat/gps`)
- Use `fix/` prefix for bug fixes (e.g., `fix/gps-parsing`)
- Or use other descriptive prefixes like `demo/` or `test/` for miscellaneous branches
- Keep names short and descriptive
- Use dashes, not spaces

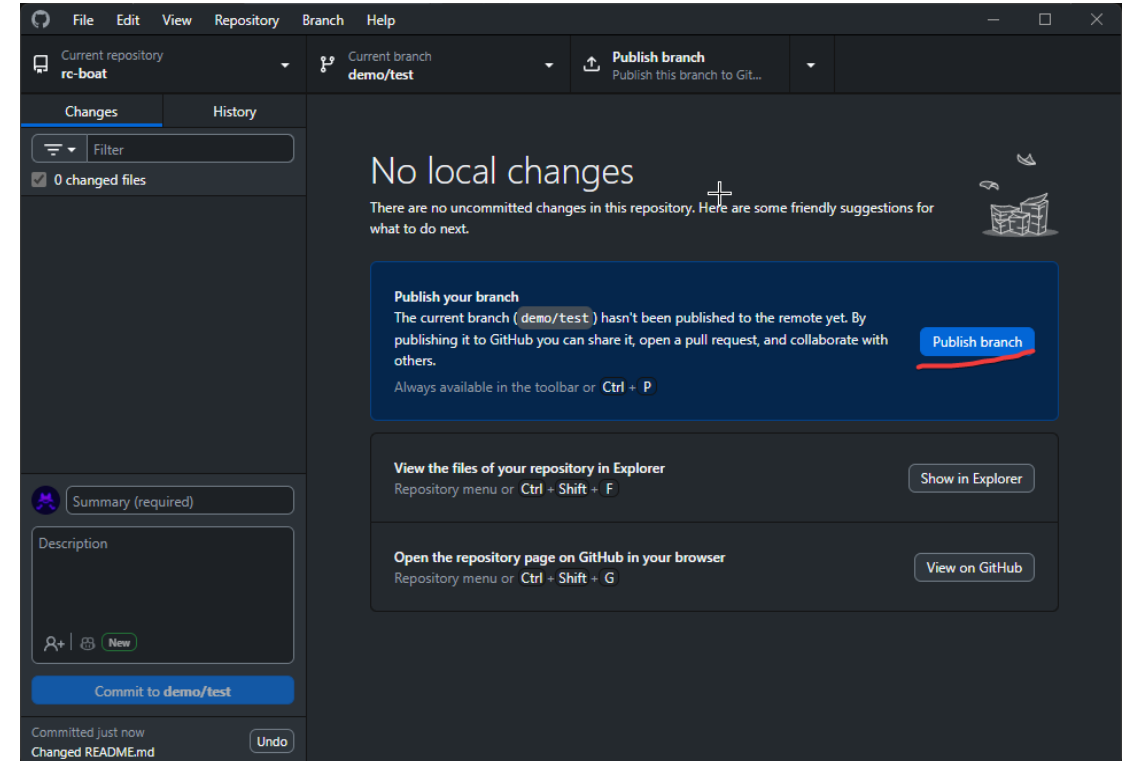
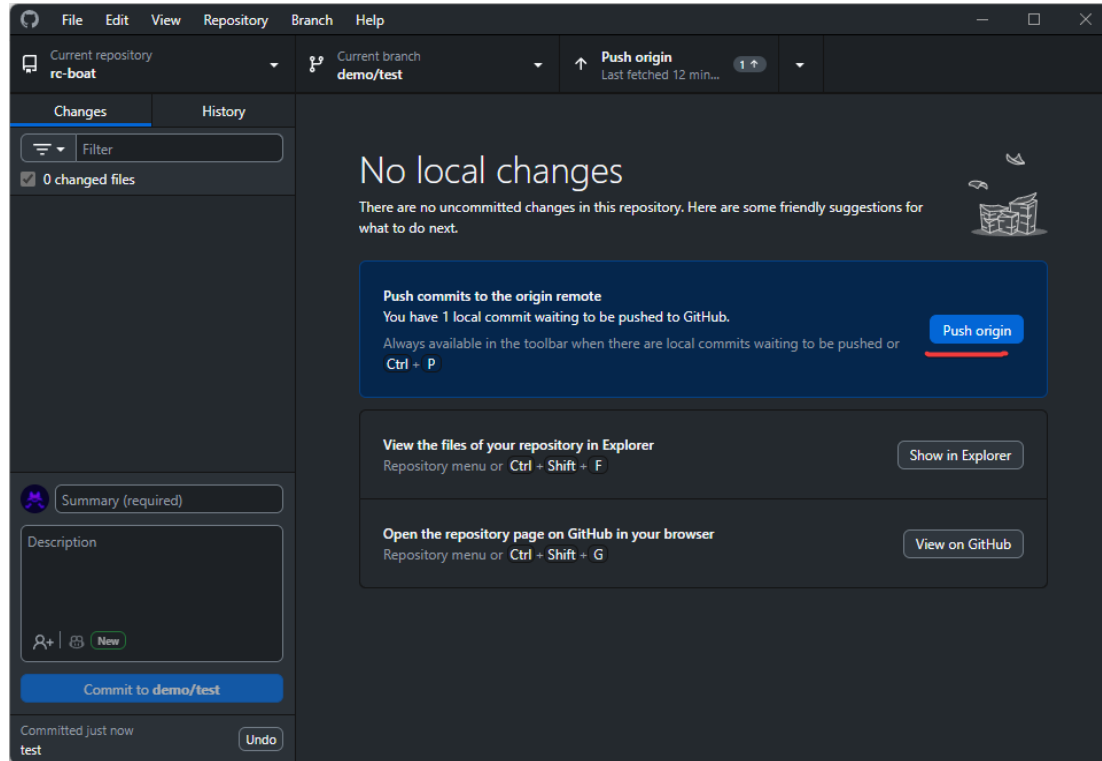
Make your changes, then make a local commit



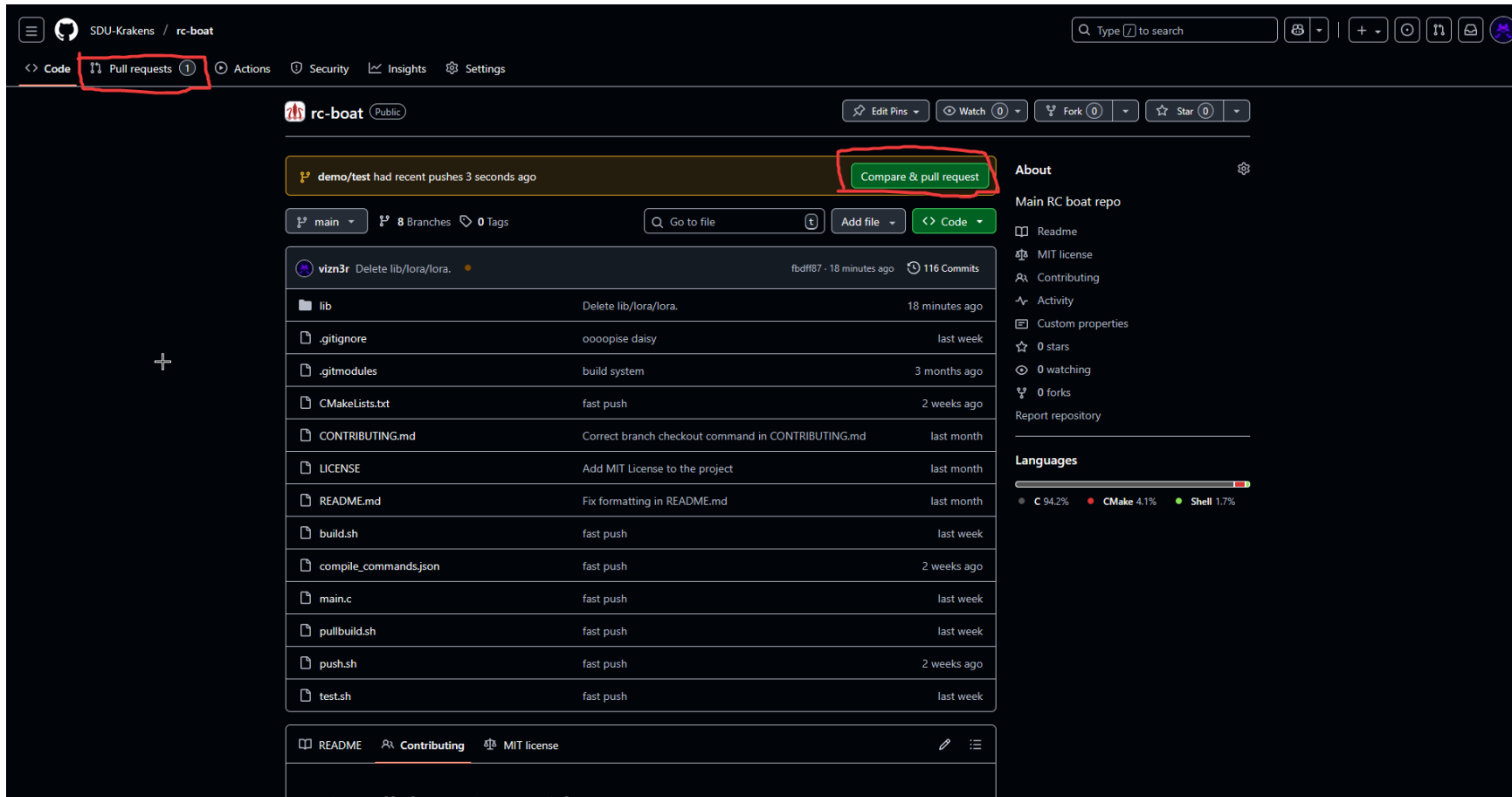
Commit message rules

-  "Add logging for UART"
-  "Fix issue where SPI crashes"
-  "stuff"
-  "changes"

Push to remote repository on GitHub



Make a pull request to merge with 'main'



Assign yourself, make a proper description and create pull request

The screenshot shows the GitHub 'Open a pull request' page for the repository 'SDU-Krakens / rc-boat'. The interface is in dark mode. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links to Code, Commits, Pull requests (1), Actions, Security, Insights, and Settings. Below this, the 'Open a pull request' section is active. It includes a header with the title 'Open a pull request' and a subtitle 'Create a new pull request by comparing changes across two branches. If you need to, you can also [compare across forks](#). [Learn more about diff comparisons here](#).' Below the header, there's a comparison bar showing 'base: main' and 'compare: demo/test' with a green checkmark and the text 'Able to merge. These branches can be automatically merged.' The main form has two sections: 'Add a title' and 'Add a description'. The 'Add a title' section has a text input field containing 'Changed README.md', which is highlighted with a red box. The 'Add a description' section has a text area with the text 'deleted a line, added a line', which is also highlighted with a red box. To the right of the description text area, there's a sidebar with sections for 'Reviewers', 'Assignees', 'Labels', 'Projects', 'Milestone', and 'Helpful resources'. The 'Assignees' section is highlighted with a red box and shows 'No one—assign yourself'. At the bottom of the form, there's a green button labeled 'Create pull request' with a dropdown arrow, which is also highlighted with a red box. Below the form, there's a summary bar showing '1 commit', '1 file changed', and '1 contributor'. At the bottom, there's a commit history section showing 'Commits on Dec 1, 2025' and a commit titled 'Changed README.md' by user 'vizz3r' committed 13 minutes ago.

SDU-Krakens / rc-boat

Type to search

<> Code <> Commits <> Pull requests 1 <> Actions <> Security <> Insights <> Settings

Open a pull request

Create a new pull request by comparing changes across two branches. If you need to, you can also [compare across forks](#). [Learn more about diff comparisons here](#).

base: main compare: demo/test ✓ Able to merge. These branches can be automatically merged.

Add a title

Changed README.md

Add a description

Write Preview H B I

deleted a line, added a line

Markdown is supported Paste, drop, or click to add files

Reviewers

No reviews—at least 1 approving review is required.

Assignees

No one—assign yourself

Labels

None yet

Projects

None yet

Milestone

No milestone

Helpful resources

[Contributing](#)
[GitHub Community Guidelines](#)

Create pull request

1 commit 1 file changed 1 contributor

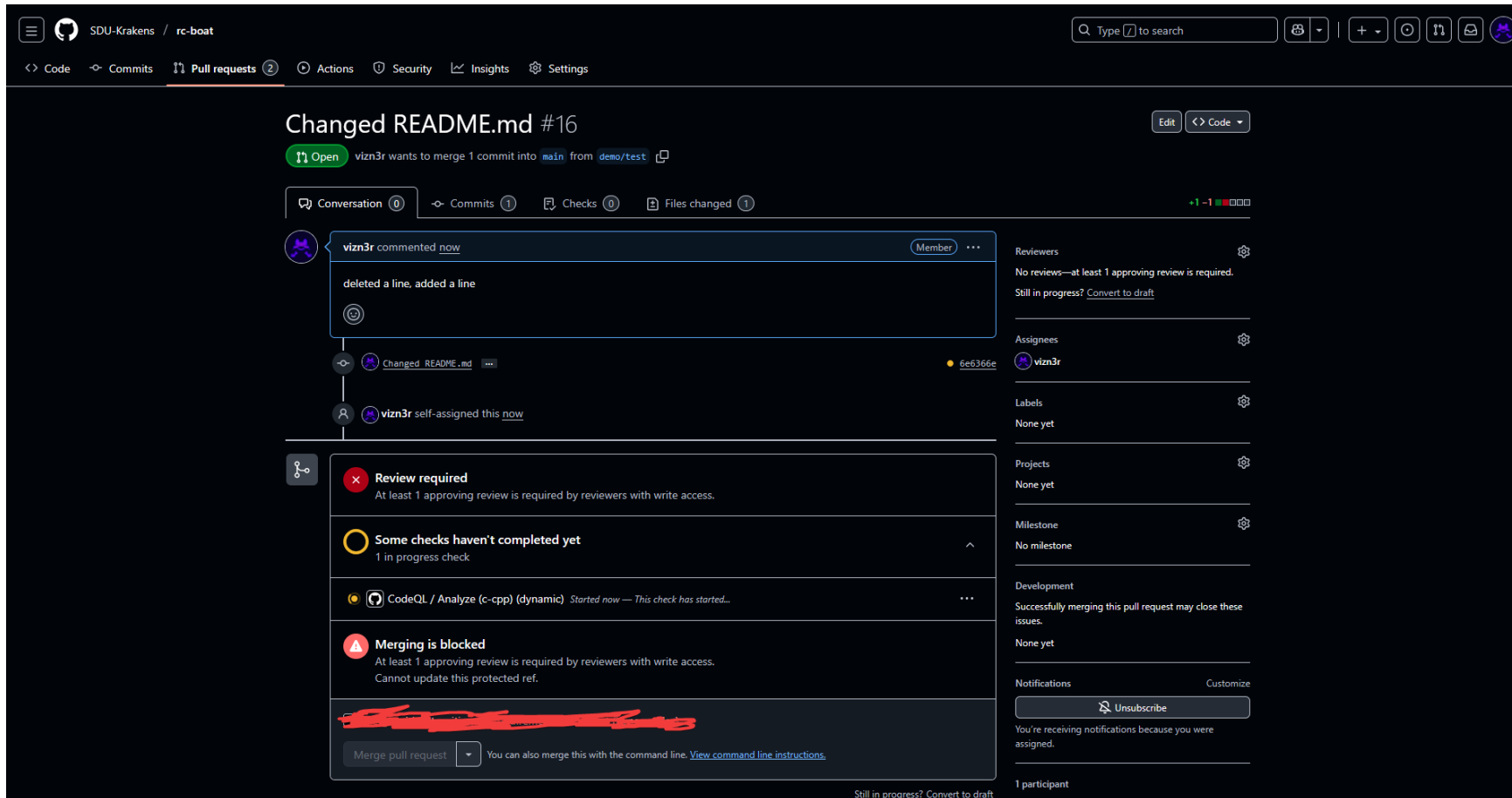
Commits on Dec 1, 2025

Changed README.md

vizz3r committed 13 minutes ago

6e6366e <>

Wait for approval from another person (probably me)



SDU-Krakens / rc-boat

Type to search

Code Commits Pull requests 2 Actions Security Insights Settings

Changed README.md #16

Open vzn3r wants to merge 1 commit into main from demo/test

Conversation 0 Commits 1 Checks 0 Files changed 1

vzn3r commented now

deleted a line, added a line

Changed README.md

vzn3r self-assigned this now

Review required
At least 1 approving review is required by reviewers with write access.

Some checks haven't completed yet
1 in progress check

CodeQL / Analyze (c-cpp) (dynamic) Started now — This check has started...

Merging is blocked
At least 1 approving review is required by reviewers with write access.
Cannot update this protected ref.

Merge pull request You can also merge this with the command line. [View command line instructions.](#)

Reviewers
No reviews—at least 1 approving review is required.
Still in progress? [Convert to draft](#)

Assignees
vzn3r

Labels
None yet

Projects
None yet

Milestone
No milestone

Development
Successfully merging this pull request may close these issues.
None yet

Notifications
[Unsubscribe](#)
You're receiving notifications because you were assigned.

1 participant

Still in progress? [Convert to draft](#)

Rules to remember

1. **Never commit directly to 'main'** - always use a feature branch
2. **Always pull from 'main' before creating a new branch** - start with the latest code
3. **Naming rules** - to make it look nice and professional
4. **Keep your PRs focused** - one feature or fix per PR
5. **Test your code** before creating a PR
6. **Ask questions** - if you're confused, others probably are too

That's it!